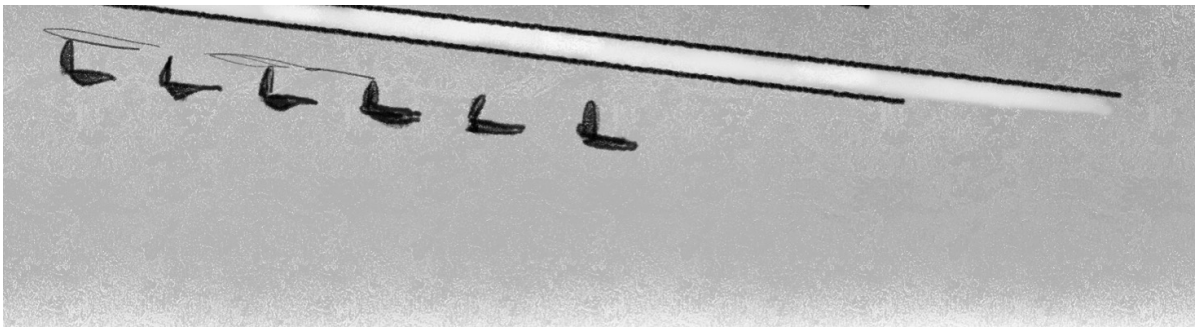


Shah Jahan held court twice a day. Common people could come to ask favors from him. Every morning he appeared at a window in the wall of the fort so that people could see he was alive. On his birthday he had himself weighed four times. The first time, the scales were balanced against an equal amount of silver. The second time, against gold and precious stones. The third time, against cloth woven with gold, silver, and silk. Finally, against a variety of foods. All of these were then given out to the people. No wonder he was a popular ruler.

